

Bravo Cheered In Miner Sweep

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

Coach Andy Cohen said Tuesday was "Art Bravo's greatest day in a Miner uniform."

Bravo was just happy his game has started to take from as the University of Texas at El Paso second baseman led the Miners to a 7-5 and 6-1 sweep over Colorado State with both his bat and glove.

Bravo was Mr. Do-It-All in the opener, banging three doubles off the boards at Dudley Field, scoring four runs, knocking one teammate home, and turning two double plays besides making a diving stop of a grounder which prevented CSU from tying UTEP in the last stages of the game.

Earlier in the season, Bravo, the team captain, had trouble fielding a simple ground ball. Nothing seemed to go right for the junior.

"Art looked like the Bravo I expected," said Cohen after the Miners

improved their record to 13-6. "He's finally starting to find himself."

Bravo said it was not so much finding himself but the fact that UTEP has been playing its games at Dudley Field and Cruz Blanca Stadium in Juarez.

"The field has a lot to do with it," admitted Bravo who was redshirted last season with a leg injury. "We're not playing on high school fields (Tech) anymore. I can't get psyched out on a field like this and also, the competition has a lot to do with it. We're starting to play much better opponents."

Two UTEP errors led to CSU's first run in the initial inning but the Miners tied the game at 1-1 with a leadoff double by Bravo and a Ram error by second baseman Keith Lening.

In the third, Jim Bradford singled and scored on Bravo's second double. Two outs later, Dan Feagler slapped a single to right scoring

Bravo.

The Miners increased their lead in the fifth to 6-1 on Bravo's third double, a run-scoring single by Orlando Cordova, a single off Feagler's bat and Sal Flores' two-run double to right-center field.

UTEP starter Jerry Walker got himself into trouble in the sixth by giving up a single and walk to CSU's first two batters. Russ Bortell was called to the mound and immediately gave up another single to load the bases and then walked Tony Antolini to force in one run.

Eric Kurosawa's ground-out scored the second run and Doug Hopkins' two-bagger down the left field line cut UTEP's margin to 6-5.

After Bravo scored UTEP's final run in the bottom of the sixth, Bortell settled down and retired the Rams in the seventh for the win.

"I was extremely happy to see Bortell stick in there. He was under a lot of pressure and showed a lot of

heart and guts," Cohen said.

The Miners spotted the Rams a run in the third inning of the second game before breaking the contest open with a four-run rally in the bottom of the frame on Cordova's two-run triple, a sacrifice fly by Bob Alsop and Rick Perez triple to right after Rich Hildebrand had doubled to right-center.

UTEP added two runs in the fifth on run-scoring singles by Hildebrand and Danny Haygood to help righthander Jim Sacco nail down his second win against two losses.

Colorado State fell to 5-7 for the year.

First Game	
UTEP 7, Colorado State 5	
CSU	001 004 0-5 10 2
UTEP	102 031 x-7 8 3
Mark Huisman and Tony Antolini: Jerry Walker, Russ Bortell (4) and Sal Flores: W-Walker (2-0). L-Huisman (2-1).	

Second Game	
UTEP 6, Colorado State 1	
CSU	001 000 0-1 4 0
UTEP	004 020 x-8 6 0
Rick Thompson, Robert Grogan (4) and Eric Kurosawa: Jim Sacco and Rich Hildebrand: W-Sacco (2-2). L-Thompson (0-2).	

Zotz Gets The Breaks With Changeup Pitch

By MARK LEIBSON
Times Sports Writer

For years, Wes Zotz never knew a changeup existed in his arsenal of pitches. He had a proven slider and a "pretty good" fast ball and of course the slider, but that was it.

Toward the end of last year's season, the University of Texas at El Paso righthander was sitting in the dugout one day with catcher Sal Flores. Flores, who had originally had been an outfielder, suggested to Zotz the possibility of throwing a breaking pitch.

Zotz went home to San Antonio and worked on the pitch in a summer baseball league. The results have been outstanding.

So far during the 1978 season, Zotz has been a giant killer on the mound for the Miners.

His secret has not been an overpowering fast ball or sharp slicing curve. "It's my changeup which has helped me this year," explained the 165-pound senior who already has five victories to his credit without defeat. "I don't have the physical size to finesse them so I really started concentrating on my changeup."

So far, Zotz has been one of the few pitchers for Cohen who can do it all.

Last Friday night, knowing he was in line to start Saturday's game against Denver University, Zotz went up to Cohen after the Miners had gotten themselves in a serious jam and told the UTEP coach he felt strong enough to go in if Cohen needed him.

After the Pioneers rallied from a 6-0 deficit to tie the game in the top of the ninth with runners on second and third

and one out, Cohen went with his 5-for-9 starter in relief.

Zotz responded with back-to-back strikeouts and then sat on the bench while Rick Perez slugged a run-scoring double in the bottom of the ninth to give Zotz his fourth win of the season.

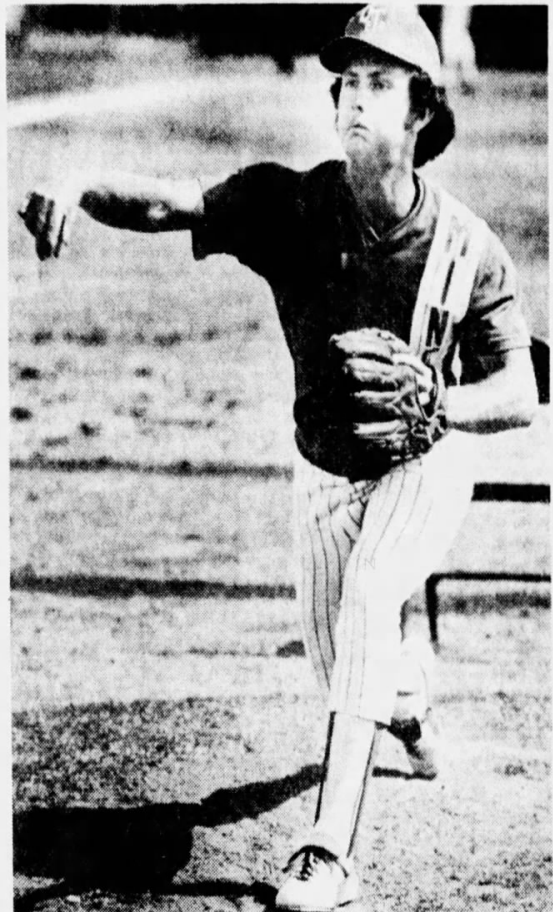
Saturday, Zotz went to the mound and threw nine innings of shutout ball. His fifth victory came during UTEP's 15th game of the year. As junior, Zotz' 15th win wasn't recorded until the Miners' 31st game.

"A lot of my success has to do with the team I have playing behind me," said Zotz. "Last year, I felt like I had to do it all myself. We had outfielders dropping balls but this year, we have guys out there who have speed and can catch the ball. This year, I just have to worry about putting the ball over the plate. We have outstanding defense and a bunch of depth at all the infield positions and in the outfield. Those guys in the outfield are as quick as cats."

Following Saturday's 9-0 win, Zotz' earned run average looked as though the right-hander had been pitching in Yankee Stadium's wide-open field rather than the enclosed, hitter's paradise of Dudley Field and Tech Field.

Through 25 innings, the San Antonio native had allowed only four runs. Two were unearned.

"Wes is the kind of player that you can turn your back on and he'll be there when you need him," praised Cohen. "He's dedicated and wants to work. He doesn't need anyone to push him in practice because he's giving it everything he has."



A CHANGED MAN — University of Texas at El Paso pitcher Wes Zotz found that a lot of things started changing when his changeup started working. The breaks have proved to be good so far as the Miner hurler has already recorded five victories. —(Times staff photo)